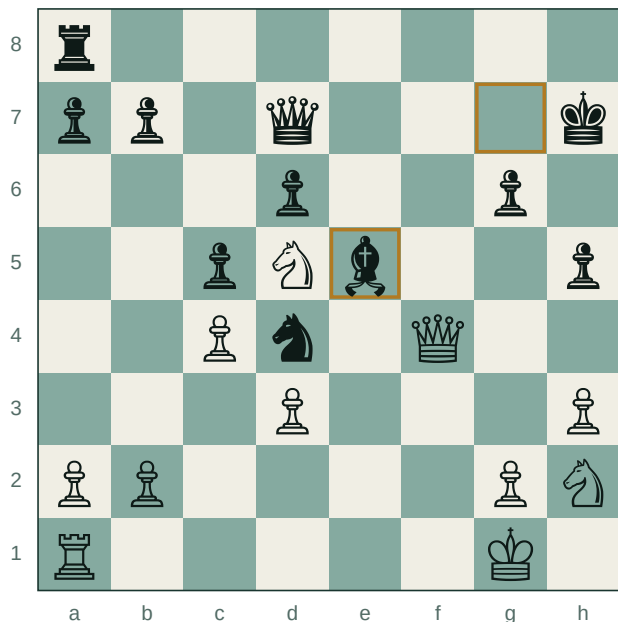


# Calculated sacrifices: White, move 23

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 22...Be5. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**23. Qxe5 24. Nf6+ Kh6 25. Nxd7**

**23.Qxe5** The queen captures the bishop on e5. Recorded reply: **23...dxe5**.

**24.Nf6+** Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From f6 it attacks king on h7 and queen on d7. Recorded reply: **24...Kh6**.

**25.Nxd7** The knight captures the queen on d7.

At the end, nominal material is White 17 / Black 14 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +3: the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on h7. Geometrically undefended: rook on a8 and queen on d7. Check for tactical protection.